Quantum Leap

Hansraj College is transforming its strong science legacy with research, innovation and industry tie-ups

By **SHELLY ANAND**



HANSRAJ COLLEGE
New Delhi
No. 3 (2025) *up from* **No. 6** (2020)

With one of the highest CGPAs (Cumulative Grade Point Average) among Delhi University colleges and a legacy of academic rigour, Hansraj has steadily worked its way towards scientific and interdisciplinary excellence.

Founded in 1948 by the DAV College Managing Committee in memory of Mahatma Hansraj, the institution has, over the past 77 years, educated millions across undergraduate and postgraduate programmes in Science, Commerce and Arts. But it is in the sciences that the college has built a formidable reputation—combining traditional academic depth with a strong culture of research.

Specialised centres such as the Har Gobind Khorana Centre for Chemical Biology and the Jagdish Chandra Bose Center for Plant Genomics bolster this research ecosystem, along with six dedicated laboratories and facilities for hydroponics, sericulture and mushroom cultivation. "Students are mentored to present their research in national and international conferences and seminars. They are also involved in the publication of research papers, books and columns in national newspapers," says principal Professor Rama. *Hans Shodh Sudha* and the *HRC Journal of Contemporary Science* are among two of the six peer-reviewed journals published by the college.

Over the past two years, Hansraj has accelerated its academic transformation. It has introduced industry-relevant certificate programmes and signed 34 MoUs with universities, colleges and companies in India and abroad. A dedicated research development cell has sanctioned more than 50 interdisciplinary projects. In the same period, faculty members have authored around 500 research papers and contributed to over 100 book chapters. Six patents have been filed and one granted—evidence of a deepening culture of innovation. Student-led start-ups such as Biomandii, Start-Up Sandesh and Oats 'n' Go have emerged from this fertile environment, reflecting the college's efforts to foster entrepreneurship.

Industry engagement is equally strong. Hansraj maintains partnerships with leading firms such as McKinsey & Company, Bain & Company, Boston Consulting Group, United Airlines, Deloitte, EY, KPMG and PwC. In 2024, the highest placement package touched Rs 36.5 lakh per annum, with an average of Rs 7.9 lakh. Placement offers have risen by 200 per cent in five years—underscoring the impact of the college's structured Industry-Institute Interface Programme.

Inclusivity remains a cornerstone of the Hansraj experience. Bridge courses, mental health support, mentorship and financial aid ensure that no student is left behind. The college's Mitti Café, staffed by specially-abled individuals, reflects this ethos.

Hansraj also carries a rich cultural lore. From Bollywood star Shah Rukh Khan treasuring his admission slip and returning decades later to collect his degree, to rare flora in its botanical garden and student-made films shot on its solar-panelled rooftop, the college continues to blend heritage with forward-looking ambition. ■